First day login: setting up your account, MFA and email

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Summary

This article guides new joiners through their first-day login at Acme Global, covering how to claim their corporate account, set a compliant password, enrol multi-factor authentication (MFA) with Microsoft Authenticator, and access Outlook email and Teams. It also provides Identity & Access Management (IAM) agents with the standard provisioning checklist to resolve day-one access tickets.

Symptoms

- Sign-in screen shows "User not found" or "Account disabled"
- Password prompt appears but password is unknown or expired
- After entering credentials, MFA prompt does not appear or fails
- Outlook/Web shows "Mailbox not found"
- Teams shows "You don't have access to any teams"

Common causes

- HR start date not yet processed - account remains disabled
- AD user object or mailbox not created during onboarding
- Required Microsoft 365 licenses (E5/E3) not assigned
- Initial password not set or communicated
- MFA registration method not configured (no Authenticator device)

Prerequisites and Information Needed

Before you begin, make sure you have your employee ID (or temporary username) from your offer letter, the name of your line manager, and access to a personal mobile phone that can receive SMS or run Microsoft Authenticator. You will also need a computer with internet access - either the corporate laptop issued to you or any personal device - to reach the password-reset portal and Office 365 web apps.

Self-Help: First-Day Login and MFA Enrollment

Follow these steps to claim your account, set a strong password, and register MFA. The process uses Acme's self-service password reset portal and the Microsoft Authenticator app for push notifications.

1. Open a browser and navigate to https://passwordreset.acme.example.
2. Enter your employee ID (or the temporary username provided by HR) and complete the CAPTCHA if shown.
3. Select "I forgot my password" and follow the prompts to create a new password that is at least 14 characters long, includes upper- and lower-case letters, numbers, and a symbol, and is not one of your last 10 passwords.
4. Sign in to Outlook on the web at https://outlook.office.com using your new password. If you are prompted to change your password again, do so now.
5. When the MFA registration screen appears, choose "Set up authenticator app". Use your smartphone to scan the QR code shown on the screen with Microsoft Authenticator.
6. Approve the push notification sent to your phone to finish MFA registration. Optionally add SMS as a backup method by following the same screen and entering your mobile number.

Verification: Confirm Access to Email and Teams

After completing the self-help steps, verify that you can reach your corporate email and Teams. This confirms that your mailbox, licenses, and MFA are all working correctly.

1. In Outlook on the web, check that your Inbox loads and you can see any welcome messages from HR or your manager.
2. Click the Teams icon (or open https://teams.microsoft.com) and verify that you are signed in and see the Acme tenant name at the top-right.

3. Send a test email to yourself (or to a colleague) and confirm it arrives in your Inbox within a minute.
4. Place a quick test call or chat in Teams to ensure audio/video permissions are granted.

Service Desk Agent Procedure: Provisioning a New Joiner Account

Use this checklist when a ticket indicates that a new joiner cannot log in on day?one. It covers AD/user creation, mailbox provisioning, licensing, initial password distribution, and MFA readiness.

1. Confirm the employee's official start date in the HR system; if the date is in the future, note that the account will remain disabled until then.
2. Search for an existing AD user object using the employee ID; if none exists, create a new user in the appropriate OU (e.g.,?OU=NewJoiners,OU=Users,DC=acme,DC=example).
3. Enable the account, set the password to a temporary compliant value (or force password change at next logon), and note the password securely for later sharing with the manager.
4. Create an Exchange Online mailbox for the user, assign the default Microsoft 365 E5 (or E3) license, and verify that an online archive is provisioned.
5. Add the user to any required distribution lists or security groups (e.g.,?All-Staff, Location-specific groups) as defined in the onboarding checklist.
6. Notify the hiring manager (via email or Teams) with the temporary password and instructions to direct the new joiner to the password-reset portal for first-time sign-in and MFA enrollment.
7. Close the ticket with resolution 'Account created and credentials shared'; if the user later reports MFA issues, escalate to the IAM team using the escalation guidance below.

When to Escalate

If the new joiner completes the self-help steps but still cannot authenticate, or if the account remains disabled after the HR start date has passed, gather the diagnostic details and engage the appropriate specialist team.

When to escalate

Escalate to the Identity & Access Management (IAM) team when: (a) the account is enabled but the user receives repeated 'MFA registration failed' errors after three attempts, (b) the mailbox does not appear in Outlook despite a valid license, or (c) the HR start date has passed and the account is still disabled. Include in the escalation: employee ID, full name, manager name, exact error messages (copy-paste or screenshot), timestamp of the failure, and any relevant screenshots of the password-reset portal or MFA registration screen. For urgent P1 cases (complete inability to access corporate resources), also notify Security Operations via the Teams channel "IT Help" and phone extension?4357 (HELP).

Keywords: first day login, new joiner, account setup, MFA enrollment, password reset, Entra ID, Active Directory, Outlook access, Teams access, onboarding, KB0010014